Growth and Development of The Preschoolers

Early Childhood

Third Stage
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Growth and Developments

Learning Objectives:

Mastery of content in this chapter will enable the student to:

1. Describe normal growth and development and common parental concerns of the preschool period.
2. Assess a preschooler for normal growth and developmental milestones.
3. Formulate nursing diagnoses related to preschool growth and development and common parental concerns.
4. Identify appropriate outcomes for nursing care of the preschooler.

5. Plan nursing care to meet the preschooler's growth and developmental needs, such as planning age-appropriate play activities.
6. Use critical thinking to analyze additional ways in which growth and developmental problems of the preschool child can be prevented and care can be family centered.
7. Integrate knowledge of preschool growth and development with nursing process to achieve quality child health nursing care.

Preschool stage (3 -5 years)

- Child begins to separate from family
- Gradually physical growth slows
- Control of the body & coordination increases
- Their world gets larger as they meet relatives, Friends, and neighbors.

Physical Growth

- Taller & thinner because children tend to grow more in height than weight.
- Brain reaches almost its adult size by 5 yrs.
- The extremities of the body grow more quickly than the body trunk.
- The posture of child gradually changes as the pelvis is straightened & the abdominal muscles become stronger.

Weight:

Weight gain is generally slow,
increasing between 18-20 kg
About 3 to 5 kg. Yearly.

Physiological Growth:

- **Pulse: 80-120 beat / min (average 100 beat / min).**
- **Respiration: 20-30 cycle / min.**
- **Blood pressure: 100/67 ± 24/25.**

Vision

- Preschool are generally hyperopic (farsighted) unable to focus on near objects
- Myopic (nearsighted).
- Both situations need eye glasses.
- This situation considered normal up to 5 years

Hearing and taste:

- The preschool has reached optimal level in ability to listen.
- In relation to the sense of taste, he/she shows their preference by asking for something and may refuse something.

Motor Development:

Age	Gross motor	Fine motor
3rd year	•Walks a straight line, backward and on tiptoes. •Catches ball with extended arms. •Kicks a ball. •Rides tricycle-using pedals	•Builds a tower of 9-10 blocks. •Use scissors with one hand. •Can undress himself. •Can put on coat without assistance. •Put beads on a string.

Motor Development:

Age	Gross motor	Fine motor
3rd years	•Run on tiptoes. Hops on preferred foot. •Alternate feet when descending stairs. •Jumps from greater heights. •Climbs from greater heights •Catches ball with extended arm and with hands	•Able to wash her/his face and brush her/his teeth. •Copies square and draw a simple face. •Cuts around picture with scissors. •buttons side buttons, bathes himself with assistance

Motor Development:

Age	Gross motor	Fine motor
4th year	•Walks a balance beam. •Skips while alternating feet. •Jumps rope & over objects. •Catches a ball smoothly with hands.	•Copies a triangle and letter. •Able to lace shoes. •Bathes self and combs hair with help. •Can blow nose when asked

Preschooler walks a balanced beam



Social Development:

A . Language

- Uses 3-7 words sentences
- Asks Why?
- Uses "I" in his speech
- Ask for the meaning of words
- Repeats sentence of 12 or more syllables.

B .Play

- More cooperative
- Understand the concept of sharing
- Needs regular socialization
- Imaginary play mates

Suggested items

- **Large space for play**
- **Field trips**
- **Dress up clothes, paints, paper, and crayons**
- **Swimming**

C .Socialization

- A need for regular interaction with age mates
- Their significant others expand beyond parents

D .Temperament

- **Characteristics observed in infancy and toddler hood persist**

- **E . Discipline**
- **Teach responsibility and inner control**
- **Agree to the limits and discipline measures**
  - **Spanking removes the responsibility from the child**
  - **Taking away a privilege is much more effective**
- **Keep the period of time out brief**
  - **The child's concept of time is not clear**

Psychosocial Development

- Egocentric in his thought & behavior, unable to see others viewpoints.
- Tolerates separation from parents by 3 years
- Separates easily by 5 years of age
- Less dependent on parents but needs their reassurance & help

- **According to Eriksson (initiative versus guilt)**
- **Eriksson views crises at this time as important for the development of the individual's self- concept & a sense of initiative**
- **He/she wants to learn what to do for himself, learn about the world and other people.**
- **If he fails to achieve this sense of initiative, he/she will develop a sense of guilt, where he will appear anxious and frightened in his contact with others**

- Demonstrates strong attachment for parent of opposite sex (Oedipus & Electra complex)
- More cooperative in play
- Becomes interested in clothes & hair styles.
- Freud theorizes that the preschooler is in the phallic stage of development

Emotional Development:

- Fears the dark.
- Tends to be impatient and selfish
- Expresses aggression through physical & verbal behaviors.
- Shows signs of jealousy.

Health protection

- **Boosters of vaccinations**
  - **Given between 4 and 6 years**
- **Annual health examination**
  - **Monitors the child's growth and development**
  - **Screens for health problems**

Topics for Family Teaching

- **Bathing**
- **Dental care**
- **Dressing**
- **Toileting**
- **Sleep needs**
- **Accident prevention**
- **Infection prevention**

Topics of Teaching to Prevent Accidents in Preschoolers

- **Seat belt use**
- **Wearing bicycle safety helmets**
- **Practicing street safety**
- **Stranger danger**
- **Fire drills**
- **Swimming safety**

Topics of Teaching to Prevent Infection in Preschoolers

- **Covering mouth when coughing or sneezing**
- **Disposing of tissues properly**
- **Correctly wiping after bowel movements**
- **Good hand washing**
- **Not sharing cups, utensils, food, or toothbrushes**

Health promotion

- **Sleep pattern:**
  toddlers needs 12hrs/day

- **Nutrition requirement: Daily caloric requirements is 90kcal/kg,about 1,800kcal/day**
- **Dental health:**
  teeth brushing and flossing

Selected health problems

Fears

Common Fears:

1. Darkness
2. Being left alone
3. Animals
4. Body mutilation
5. Pain

Sex Education

- They are acutely aware of their sexuality, including sexual roles and organs
- They generally develop a strong emotional attachment to the parent of the opposite sex
- Curiosity about sex may make parents uncomfortable and induce negative responses
- The caregiver should teach responsible sexual information
- Before answering ,understand what the child is asking
- The caregiver should teach the child "good touch" and "bad touch"

Dysfunction of bowel and bladder control

- daytime control by 4
- day and night control for bladder and bowel

Tonsillitis

Nursing Care for the Preschooler in a Health Care Facility

- Use play to act out anxieties and learn what to expect from the hospital situation
- Do not use a rectal thermometer
- Do not scold a child for reverting to bedwetting
- Follow home routines as closely as possible
- Carefully explain all procedures to the child
- Provide play material

Thank you

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